Project 1: Infrastructure

Build a New High-Speed Motorway connecting Toulouse and Lyon

Context:

The French government has identified growing passenger and freight traffic between the Occitanie and Auvergne-Rhône-Alpes regions. To improve economic exchanges and reduce travel time, a new high-capacity motorway corridor between Toulouse and Lyon is being considered.

Your team has been appointed as the project management office responsible for planning the project.

Project Objectives

- Reduce travel time between Toulouse and Lyon
- Improve freight transport efficiency
- Support regional economic development
- Ensure environmental compliance
- Deliver the project within budget and schedule constraints

Project 2: Business Expansion

Sell a Successful French Retail Brand in Japan

Context

Decathlon is one of Europe's largest sporting goods retailers. The company has achieved strong success in France thanks to its broad product portfolio, affordable prices, private-label brands, and large-format stores.

The executive committee has decided to accelerate growth outside Europe and considers Japan as a strategic market due to:

- Strong consumer purchasing power
- High interest in sports and outdoor activities
- Large urban population
- Upcoming growth opportunities in cycling, running, hiking, and fitness
- Demand for innovative and affordable sporting products

However, Japan is a highly competitive market already served by strong domestic and international players. Consumer expectations, buying behaviors, and retail practices differ significantly from those in France.

Your team has been appointed to define and manage the market entry strategy.

Strategic objectives:

- Establish the first Japanese operations of Decathlon.
- Build brand awareness among Japanese consumers.
- Develop a sustainable long-term growth strategy.

Commercial objectives:

- Open an initial network of stores in major metropolitan areas
- Launch a Japanese e-commerce platform
- Develop partnerships with local suppliers and logistics providers

Project 3: Organizational Transformation

Transform Airbus from functional departments to product-oriented teams

Context

Airbus is a global aerospace company with tens of thousands of employees distributed across multiple countries and business units. Historically, many activities are organized through specialized functional departments such as engineering, manufacturing, procurement, quality, finance, and customer support.

While this structure provides strong technical expertise, it often creates silos, lengthy decision-making processes, and coordination challenges when developing new products and services.

To improve innovation, accelerate product development, and become more customer-centric, the executive committee has launched a major transformation initiative. The objective is to reorganize the company around cross-functional product teams responsible for delivering end-to-end value to customers.

You team has been designated transformation office, to plan and manage the change program.

Project objectives

- Define a new product-oriented operating model.
- Establish cross-functional product teams with clear responsibilities.
- Redesign governance and decision-making processes.
- Clarify new roles and reporting structures.
- Ensure continuity of ongoing projects and operations during the transformation.
- Implement new collaboration tools and working practices.
- Define performance indicators for the new organization.
- Deliver the transformation within the approved budget and timeline.

Internal

Project 4: Digital Product Launch

Create an AI Academic Assistant for University Students

Context

To improve student success, engagement, and learning experience, the university's executive board has launched an initiative to develop an AI-powered Academic Assistant available through web and mobile platforms.

The assistant should help students throughout their academic journey by providing services such as study planning, exam preparation support, resource recommendations, course information, deadline reminders, and personalized learning guidance. The solution must be integrated with existing university systems while ensuring compliance with privacy and data protection requirements.

Your team acts as the product and project team responsible for defining, planning, and managing the development and launch of the new AI Academic Assistant.

Project 5: Event Planning

Prepare the Olympic Games Opening Ceremony

Context

Following the successful bid of France to host the 2036 Olympic Games, the Organizing Committee has selected Toulouse as the host city for the Opening Ceremony.

The ceremony must be an internationally televised event watched by hundreds of millions of viewers worldwide. It should showcase French culture, innovation, diversity, and the identity of the host region while ensuring the safety of athletes, officials, spectators, and performers.

The Organizing Committee chose your team to plan and deliver the event. The project involves coordinating government authorities, security services, broadcasters, sponsors, artists, logistics providers, and international sports organizations.

The ceremony has a fixed deadline: it must be fully operational on the day of the Olympic Games opening.

Project 6: Energy Transition

Transform Blagnac airport to achieve zero carbon emissions by 2045

Blagnac airport is one of the largest airports in France and a strategic hub for both commercial aviation and the aerospace industry. As governments, investors, customers, and regulators pressure to reduce greenhouse gas emissions, the airport's management has launched an ambitious energy transition program.

The objective is to transform airport operations and infrastructure to significantly reduce carbon emissions while maintaining operational performance, safety, and passenger satisfaction. The initiative must balance environmental goals with economic constraints and the needs of numerous stakeholders.

The transformation includes a broad range of potential initiatives such as renewable energy production, building energy efficiency improvements, electrification of ground operations, sustainable mobility solutions for passengers and employees, energy management systems, circular economy practices, and collaboration with airlines and industrial partners.

Your team is responsible for planning and managing the overall transformation program.

Group project objective

Working in teams, you act as the project manager for one of the six projects.

The purpose is to prepare and present the project during its official kick-off meeting, at the end of the Initiation and Planning phases of the project lifecycle.

The team must convince project sponsors and stakeholders that:

- The project is well understood
- The project scope is clearly defined
- Key stakeholders have been identified
- Major risks have been analyzed
- A realistic plan has been established
- The project is ready to enter the execution phase

The presentation simulates the project's official kick-off meeting.

- 20 minutes presentation
- 10 minutes Q&A

Assume the audience as:

- Sponsor
- Steering committee member
- Investor
- Executive committee member

Evaluation criteria

You must demonstrate:

- Clear understanding of the project
- Logical planning
- Awareness of project risks and constraints
- Professional communication
- **Ability to defend decisions**